

UNIT 6 In the Fairway

The Marina is now proceeding in the fairway. The Diana, a vessel ahead of her, is altering course to starboard. The Diana will turn at Buoy No 4. The Marina is keeping a steady course and speed, and is making a speed of 5 knots.

The Chief Mate on the Marina calls up Vessel Traffic Service:

Marina: Santander Vessel Traffic Service. This is Marina, Marina, Marina. On Channel 12. Over.

VTs: Marina, Santander Vessel Traffic Service. Channel 12. Over.

Marina: Santander Vessel Traffic Service. This is Marina. I am underway. My destination is Kotka in Finland. My cargo is bulk grain. My ETA at pilot station is 1300 local time. My draught forward is 6.5 metres and my draught aft is 7.2 metres. I have a list to port of 2 degrees. Over.

VTs: Marina, Santander Vessel Traffic Service. Understood. INFORMATION: Diana will turn ahead of you at Buoy No 7. INSTRUCTION: You must wait for the Diana to clear the buoy before entering the main fairway.

Marina: Santander VTS, Marina. Understood. I am proceeding at reduced speed. I will wait for Diana to clear Buoy No 7 before entering the main fairway.

After a while the Marina gets the go ahead from the Vessel Traffic Service to enter the fairway. She is proceeding along the main fairway, steering a course of 236° when suddenly the following message is heard on the VTS radio channel.

VTs: All ships, all ships, all ships. This is Santander VTS, Santander VTS, Santander VTS.
INFORMATION: Visibility is slightly reduced by rain. Visibility at Isla de Mouro Lighthouse is one thousand metres. Visibility is expected to decrease to 500 metres during the next hour. There are dredging

operations in position north side of fairway at Las Querantas.
ADVICE: Vessels are advised to navigate with caution.

While the Marina is getting well underway in the fairway, a vessel ahead of her, the Seagull, has run into trouble. The following radio communication is heard on Channel 16:

Seagull: Pan-Pan, Pan-Pan, Pan-Pan.
This is Seagull, Seagull, Seagull.
My position is 180° one cable from Light Buoy No 4. Our vessel is not under command. I need immediate tug assistance.
Over.

Rescue Centre: Pan-Pan.
Seagull.
This is Rescue Centre Santander.
Received Pan-Pan.
We are sending tugs to you. Towing assistance will reach you in 20 minutes.
QUESTION: Are you carrying dangerous cargo?
Over.

Seagull: Rescue Centre Santander.
This is Seagull. Engines are not working. Our vessel is not under command. We are carrying flammable cargo.
Over.

After a little while the Rescue Centre sends the following message on channel 16.

Pan-Pan, Pan-Pan, Pan-Pan
All stations, all stations, all stations
This is Rescue Centre Santander, Rescue Centre Santander, Rescue Centre Santander with Pan message No 1.
Vessel Seagull in position bearing 072° from Isla de Mouro Lighthouse, distance one mile, is not under command, awaiting tug assistance.

Seagull is carrying flammable cargo. Vessels are advised to keep clear of the area.

I repeat.

This is Rescue Centre Santander, Rescue Centre Santander, Rescue Centre Santander with Pan message No 1.

Vessel Seagull in position bearing 072° from Isla de Mouro Lighthouse, distance one mile, is not under command, awaiting tug assistance.

Seagull is carrying flammable cargo. Vessels are advised to keep clear of the area. Date and time: 141315 local time.

And on the VTS channel the Marina receives the following message:

Santander VTS: Marina.
Santander VTS.
WARNING: You are proceeding on a dangerous course.
Vessel ahead of you in position 43° 28.7' N, 003° 44.1' W is not under command. It is dangerous to approach the Seagull.
ADVICE: You must pass Seagull at a wide berth. Over.

Marina: Santander VTS.
Marina.
ADVICE RECEIVED. I will pass Seagull at reduced speed and keep a wide berth.

With the help of several tugs, the Seagull gradually gets underway on the opposite course and heads back to the Port of Santander for repairs. And the Rescue Centre can give the all clear:

Pan-Pan, Pan-Pan, Pan-Pan
All stations, all stations, all stations
This is Rescue Centre Santander, Rescue Centre Santander, Rescue Centre Santander.
Please cancel Pan message dated 141315 local time.
Seagull is proceeding inward with tug assistance. Fairway now clear.
Vessels may proceed.
This is Rescue Centre Santander.

The Marina is now free to head for the open sea and the Bay of Biscay. The pilot leaves the ship. “Bon voyage!” he calls, as he climbs down the ladder to the pilot cutter.

Now let us take a closer look at the verbs used in SMCP for THE SHIP'S MOVEMENTS IN THE FAIRWAY. Study these sentences. The underlined expressions are used in the Standard Communication Phrases. Use them on the radio.

to leave

The ship is leaving port.

to depart

to enter

The ship is entering the main fairway.

to come into/go into

to get underway

The Marina is getting underway.

to start moving forward

Her destination is Kotka.

in the water

to proceed

She is proceeding at reduced speed.

to continue; to go on

to alter course

She is altering course to starboard.

to change course

to turn

The Fantasia is turning at Buoy No 1.

to change direction

to keep course

The Utopia is keeping her course and speed.

and speed

to proceed with

the same course and speed

to make speed

She is making a speed of 15 knots.

to have a speed

to pass

She is passing many ships in the fairway.

to go past

to overtake

to go faster past a ship
in the same direction

"Do not **overtake**. I repeat: Do not
overtake".

to stay clear of

to stay away from

Rescue operations in position... Vessels
must **stay clear of** the fairway...

to approach

to come near

The Utopia **is approaching** the outer buoy.

to drift

to move with
the wind and sea

Engine trouble! We are **drifting** towards the
coast.

Prepositions of place are very important at sea. Study the following:

in

The cargo is **in** the hold.

at

Turn port **at** the lighthouse.

to

The ship is sailing **to** Helsinki.

on

The men are working **on** deck.

from

It is coming **from** Germany.

into

Load the cargo **into** the hold.

out of

Unload it **out of** the hold.

towards

The ship is drifting **towards** the rocks.

up/down

Climb **up** the mast! Climb **down** again!

away from

The ship is drifting **away from** the shore.

across

Do not go **across** the fairway!

along

Proceed **along** the fairway!

below

The cabins are **below** deck.

under

What is **under** this tarpaulin? = (canvas cover)

past

The vessel is going **past** buoy Nr 2.

over

The helicopter is flying **over** the ship.

round

He is swimming **round** the rock.

through

He is swimming **through** the shoal.

ahead of/ in front of

Do not pass **ahead** of me.

astern/behind

Pass **astern of** the sailing boat.

MORE PREPOSITIONS

Notice the use of prepositions in the following expressions that have to do with ships and seafaring.

The ship is **at sea**. The head line is **at the bow**.

The passengers are going **on board** the ship.

The Captain is **on the navigation bridge**. There are 1 500 passengers **on this ship**.

We are now **on the open sea**.

We are on our way **to the open sea**.

Helsinki is **on the coast**.

The ship is **on course**. The ship is **off course**.

There are many islands **off the coast** of Finland.

The Marina is **getting off from** the quay. **Cast off** from the bollards.

The ship is **heading towards** the coast.

The ship is **in the fairway**.

Ten degrees **to starboard**.

Stand by with the towing line.

SEAMARKS, LIGHTS AND BUOYS

The IALA System of Buoyage

The IALA (International Association of Lighthouse Authorities) **System of Buoyage** applies to all fixed and floating marks in the fairways, except lighthouses, sector lights, leading lights and leading marks, lightvessels and Lanbys. The standard buoy shapes are cylindrical (can), conical, spherical, pillar and spar.

Cardinal Marks

In the IALA Buoyage System **Cardinal Marks** are divided into four groups, corresponding to the four points of the compass. They are **the North Cardinal Mark, the East Cardinal Mark, the South Cardinal Mark and the West Cardinal Mark**. The name indicates on which side of the mark a vessel should pass. The colours used are black and yellow. The marks are equipped with light reflectors in different combinations of blue and yellow. The Cardinal marks may or may not be equipped with lights and topmarks (black cones).

E.g. **The North Mark** is black over yellow in colours. It should be passed on the north side. Top marks are two black cones, one above the other and with points upwards. The North Mark has two light reflectors blue over yellow. When a light is fitted it is white in colour and gives a very quick flash or a quick flash.

The East Mark is black with a yellow band in colour. Top marks are two black cones with their bases together. When a light is fitted it is white in colour and gives three very quick flashes every five seconds, or three quick flashes every ten seconds.

The Cardinal Marks may appear in different forms such as Spar Buoys, Beacon Buoys, Buoys, Lighted Buoys, Ice Buoys, Lighted Ice Buoys, Rand Marks and Lighted Rand Marks. Rand Marks indicate the borders of the fairway.

Lateral Marks

Lateral Marks are divided into Starboard Marks and Port Marks corresponding to the main direction of the fairway. Consequently when proceeding in the main direction of the fairway, The Starboard Mark should be on the starboard side and The Port Mark on the port side of the vessel.

The main direction of the fairway is usually that taken when approaching a harbour from seaward. Where the fairway direction is not obvious, as for example in fairways following the coast, the direction of buoyage is usually marked by symbols on the charts. In the Archipelago Sea and The Gulf of Bothnia the main direction in the coastal fairways is from south to north, and in The Gulf of Finland from west to east.

The Port Mark is red, has a cylindrical top mark and a red light reflector. The Port Mark gives one red flash followed by a short pause.

The Starboard Mark is green, has a green light reflector and a green cone as topmark. The Starboard Mark flashes one green flash followed by a short pause.

Lateral Marks may also be without lights or topmarks.

The Isolated Danger Mark is black in colour with red bands. It indicates that the mark is on the rock and the mark may be passed on either side. It can be either pillar-shaped or spar-shaped. Top marks are two black spheres one above the other. When a light is fitted it is white and flashes in groups of two.

The Safe Water Mark is red with white vertical stripes. It is spherical in shape, pillar-shaped or spar-shaped. Top marks, which are optional on spherical buoys, are a single red sphere. When a light is fitted it is white in colour and it either flashes or occults or is isophase.

The Special Mark is yellow in colour. The topmark is a yellow cross. It indicates some special feature in the fairway such as e.g. a national border, cables, dredging area etc.

L i g h t h o u s e s

A **Lighthouse** can be a solitary structure way out in the open sea far away from channels. Bogskär on a solitary rock in the northern Baltic Sea and Bengtskär in the Gulf of Finland are examples of such Finnish lighthouses. But often the lighthouse is the first light to be seen at the outer end of a fairway or channel, and it may have both lighted and dark sectors. Lighthouses are often fitted with racons and radar reflectors.

A Sector Light is smaller than a lighthouse. Sector lights are common in coastal fairways like the Finnish archipelago. A sector light has several coloured and dark sectors. It marks the borders of the fairway. The white light is directed towards the fairway. When the ship is approaching the lighthouse the white light is flanked by a red sector on the port side and a green sector on the starboard side.

Leading Lights or Marks are one of two or three objects in line. The leading line shows the course to be navigated, bearings are given in degrees and minutes on charts.

Directions Lights mark the course to be followed but are not in line with any other mark. A direction light usually has a narrow sector of light, marking the course to be followed, flanked by darkness or unintensified light.

Light Range

In the List of Lights the light range in nautical miles is noted as a nominal range. It is the range of light at night when the visibility is 10 nautical miles.

Light Character

Lighthouses and light buoys are equipped with many different light characters.

Fixed light	Continuous, constant light.
Occulting light	Total duration of light is longer than total duration of darkness. Occulting light can be of different kinds: Single-occulting light, Group occulting and Composite group-occulting.
Isophase light	The duration of light and darkness is equal.
Flashing light	The total duration of light is shorter than the total duration of darkness. The flashing light can be of many different kinds and combinations: Single-flashing, Group flashing, Composite group flashing and Long-flashing light.

Quick flash can appear as Continuous quick flash, Group quick flash and Interrupted quick flash. **Very quick flash** may appear as Continuous very quick, Group very quick and Interrupted very quick. **Ultra quick flash** appears as Continuous ultra quick or Interrupted ultra quick. There is also **Morse Light**.